

Securing a LAMP Server *in 2019*

LAMP is an acronym for a stack typically consisting of the Linux operating system, the Apache HTTP Server, the MySQL relational database management system, and the PHP programming language. It is a platform mainly used to develop dynamic websites. Let's take a look at how we can secure a LAMP server today.



Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP – the famed LAMP stack comprises easily one of the most popular open source technology components used in conjunction with each other to run the Web. Although newer technologies with promising features have emerged over the years, LAMP has stood the test of time, still powering most of the Internet today.

As a technology grows popular, it gets attention from both attackers and developers. Although LAMP has become very mature over the years and is powering a lot of big organisations all around the world, it isn't perfect and has its upsides and downsides.

Most of the weaknesses can be addressed by simply following a list of best practices and that doesn't take long. Let us look at some of the ways we can make Web applications significantly stronger and attack-resistant.

Let's start by tweaking a weak system!

Securing Linux

We are going to use Ubuntu 18.04 for this tutorial, although the steps are almost the same in some other non-Debian based variants.

User access control and privileges: Log in to the system for the first time as the root user, as follows:

```
ssh root@ip_address_of_your_server
```

After you are done logging into your root account, create a new user to operate the server and do not use the root account.

This is because the root has elevated privileges to do anything in the system, which could allow other users to make destructive changes. Using the root account as default is a bad idea because we humans tend to make a lot of mistakes and cannot take chances in a production environment.

We create a new user called *webadmin* that we will be using to handle our Web server.

```
# adduser webadmin
```

Then you will be prompted to add a password and other credentials. Set a strong password and then hit *Enter* to skip any field.